

## Chapter 25 — "Spot the Niphal" Passage Exercise

Genesis 3, 6, and 21 · The Garden, the Flood Prelude, and Beersheba

Most highlighted verbs are Niphal forms. For each one, first answer Is it Niphal? (Yes / No). If Yes: parse conjugation, PGN, and root, then state the semantic function (Passive / Reflexive / Middle / Simple Action). If No: identify the correct stem and parse fully. Part C contains distractor verbs — not Niphal. Answer key begins on the page marked "Answer Key".

### Passage A — Genesis 3:5–10

3:5

וַהֲיִיתֶם כְּאֱלֹהִים יְדֹעֵי טוֹב וָרָע כִּי יָדַע אֱלֹהִים כִּי בַיּוֹם אֲכַלְתֶּם מִמֶּנּוּ וּנְפָקוּחַ עֵינֵיכֶם

"...for God knows that in the day you eat of it your eyes will [1] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 1 | וּנְפָקוּחַ | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

3:6

וְנֹחַמָּד הָעֵץ לְהַשְׂכִּיל

"...and that the tree was desirable to make one wise."

| # | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 2 | וְנֹחַמָּד | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

3:7

וּתְפַקְחֶנָּה עֵינֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם

"Then the eyes of both of them [3] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb           | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|----------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 3 | וּתְפַקְחֶנָּה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

3:10

וְאִירָא כִּי־עִירָם אָנֹכִי וְאֶחָבָא

"I was afraid, because I was naked, and [4] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb      | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|-----------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 4 | וְאֶחָבָא | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

### Passage B — Genesis 6:6–12

6:6

וַיִּנָּחַם יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ

"And the LORD [5] \_\_\_\_ that he had made man on the earth."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 5 | וַיִּנָּחַם | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

6:7

נַחֲמַתִּי כִּי עָשִׂיתֶם

"I [6] \_\_\_\_ that I made them."

| # | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 6 | נַחֲמַתִּי | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

6:11

וַתִּשְׁחַת הָאָרֶץ ... וַתִּמְלֹא הָאָרֶץ חָמָס

"The earth [7] \_\_\_\_ ... and the earth [8] \_\_\_\_ with violence."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 7 | וַתִּשְׁחַת | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |
| 8 | וַתִּמְלֹא  | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

6:12

וְהִנֵּה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי־הִשְׁחִית כָּל־בָּשָׂר

"and behold, it [9] \_\_\_\_, for all flesh had corrupted its way."

| # | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|---|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 9 | נִשְׁחָתָה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

6:21

וְהָיָה לָהֶם לְאֹכֶל וְלָהֶם לְאֹכֶל יֵאָכֵל

"it shall be food for you and for them — it shall [10] \_\_\_\_."

| #  | Verb    | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|----|---------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 10 | יֵאָכֵל | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

## Passage C — Genesis 21:23–31

21:23

הַשְּׂבָעָה לִּי בְּאֵלֵהֶם הִנֵּה

"[11] \_\_\_\_ to me by God here."

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|----|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 11 | הַשְּׂבָעָה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

21:24

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם אֲנֹכִי אֲשָׁבַע

"And Abraham said, 'I [12] \_\_\_\_.'"

| #  | Verb     | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function             |
|----|----------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| 12 | אֲשָׁבַע | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> |

21:31

כִּי שָׁם נִשְׁבְּעוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם

*"For there [13] \_\_\_\_ both of them."*

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation | PGN | Root | Function |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----|------|----------|
| 13 | נִשְׁבְּעוּ |             |     |      |          |

### Bonus — Genesis 21:3, 21:8

21:3

אֲשֶׁר-נִוְלַד-לּוֹ

*"who had been born to him"*

21:8

וַיִּגְדַּל הַיֶּלֶד וַיִּגְמַל

*"And the child grew and was weaned."*

| #  | Verb       | Conjugation | PGN | Root | Function |
|----|------------|-------------|-----|------|----------|
| B1 | נִוְלַד    |             |     |      |          |
| B2 | וַיִּגְמַל |             |     |      |          |

### Part C — Distractor Check

These three verbs come from the same passages. None are Niphal. Answer "No" for Niphal? and complete the full parse.

3:6

וַתֵּרָא הָאִשָּׁה כִּי טוֹב הָעֵץ לְמַאֲכֹל

*"So when the woman [D1] \_\_\_\_ that the tree was good for food."*

| #  | Verb     | Conjugation | PGN | Root | Function |
|----|----------|-------------|-----|------|----------|
| D1 | וַתֵּרָא |             |     |      |          |

6:6

כִּי עָשָׂה אֶת-הָאָדָם בְּאֶרֶץ

*"that he [D2] \_\_\_\_ mankind on the earth."*

| #  | Verb   | Conjugation | PGN | Root | Function |
|----|--------|-------------|-----|------|----------|
| D2 | עָשָׂה |             |     |      |          |

21:8

וַיִּגְדַּל הַיֶּלֶד

*"And [D3] \_\_\_\_ the child."*

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation | PGN | Root | Function |
|----|-------------|-------------|-----|------|----------|
| D3 | וַיִּגְדַּל |             |     |      |          |

Items 5–6 (■■■■■■■■■■ / ■■■■■■■■■■) are both from ■■■■■■, a verb that occurs almost exclusively in the Niphal. Items 11–13 all parse as Reflexive from ■■■■■■ — notice how Imperative, Imperfect, and Weqatal all express the same oath-swearing action.

**Score: 13 main + 2 bonus = 15 total. 13–15 = excellent | 9–12 = review the paradigm | below 9 = revisit §23.3–23.13**

## Conjugation Coverage

| Conjugation     | Verbs                                                                |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wayyiqtol (5)   | #3, #5, #7, #8, B2                                                   |
| Weqatal (5)     | #1, #6, #9, #13, B1                                                  |
| Imperfect (2)   | #10, #12                                                             |
| Participle (1)  | #2                                                                   |
| Imperative (1)  | #11                                                                  |
| Distractors (3) | D1 (Qal Wayyiqtol 3fs), D2 (Qal Perfect 3ms), D3 (Qal Wayyiqtol 3ms) |

## Reflection Questions

1. Every Niphal in Passage A (Gen 3) involves eyes, hiding, or desire. What does the Niphal contribute to the theological message of the Fall narrative?
2. In Gen 6:6–7, God is the subject of a Niphal-only verb (■■■■■). What does this choice tell us about how the narrator portrays God's emotional response?
3. Compare Gen 3:5 (■■■■■■■■■■ — "will be opened," Middle/Tolerative) with Gen 3:7 (■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ — "were opened," Middle). Is the function identical in both? What difference in nuance, if any, does the shift from weqatal to wayyiqtol suggest?

## Answer Key

Passages with correct answers shown in the green row below each verb.

### Passage A — Genesis 3:5–10

3:5

וַיֵּיתֶם כְּאֵלֵהִים יָדַעַי טוֹב וְרָע כִּי יָדַע אֱלֹהִים כִּי בַיּוֹם אֲכַלְכֶּם מִמֶּנּוּ וְנִפְקְחוּ עֵינֵיכֶם

"...for God knows that in the day you eat of it your eyes will [1] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 1 | וְנִפְקְחוּ | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | וְנִפְקְחוּ | Weqatal              | 3cp                  | פִּקַּח              | Middle — will be opened    |

3:6

וְנִחְמַד הָעֵץ לַהֲשִׁילָהּ

"...and that the tree was desirable to make one wise."

| # | Verb      | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                                |
|---|-----------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 2 | וְנִחְמַד | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓              |
| ✓ | וְנִחְמַד | Participle ms        | ms                   | חָמַד                | Passive — desirable (substantival ptc.) |

3:7

וַתִּפְקְחוּהָ עֵינֵי שְׁנֵיהֶם

"Then the eyes of both of them [3] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb           | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|---|----------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 3 | וַתִּפְקְחוּהָ | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | וַתִּפְקְחוּהָ | Wayyiqtol            | 3fp                  | פִּקַּח              | Middle — they were opened  |

3:10

וַאֲיֹרָא כִּי־עִירַם אָנֹכִי וְאֶחְבֵּא

"I was afraid, because I was naked, and [4] \_\_\_\_."

| # | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|---|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 4 | וְאֶחְבֵּא | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | וְאֶחְבֵּא | Wayyiqtol            | 1cs                  | חָבֵא                | Reflexive — I hid myself   |

### Passage B — Genesis 6:6–12

6:6

וַיַּנְחֶם יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ

"And the LORD [5] \_\_\_\_ that he had made man on the earth."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                               |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 5 | וַיִּנָּחֵם | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓             |
| ✓ | וַיִּנָּחֵם | Wayyiqtol            | 3ms                  | נחם                  | Simple Action (Niphal-only) — relented |

6:7

וַיִּנָּחֵם כִּי עָשִׂיתִם

"I [6] \_\_\_\_ that I made them."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                               |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 6 | וַיִּנָּחֵם | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓             |
| ✓ | וַיִּנָּחֵם | Weqatal              | 1cs                  | נחם                  | Simple Action (Niphal-only) — I regret |

6:11

וַתִּשְׁחַת הָאָרֶץ ... וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ חֲמָס

"The earth [7] \_\_\_\_ ... and the earth [8] \_\_\_\_ with violence."

| # | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|---|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 7 | וַתִּשְׁחַת | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | וַתִּשְׁחַת | Wayyiqtol            | 3fs                  | שחח                  | Passive — it was corrupted |
| 8 | וַתִּמָּלֵא | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | וַתִּמָּלֵא | Wayyiqtol            | 3fs                  | מלא                  | Passive — it was filled    |

6:12

וַהֲבֵינָה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי־הִשְׁחִית כָּל־בָּשָׂר

"and behold, it [9] \_\_\_\_, for all flesh had corrupted its way."

| # | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|---|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 9 | נִשְׁחָתָה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓ | נִשְׁחָתָה | Weqatal              | 3fs                  | שחח                  | Passive — it was corrupt   |

6:21

וְהָיָה לָהֶם לְאֹכֶל וְלָהֶם לְאֹכֶל יֵאָכֵל

"it shall be food for you and for them — it shall [10] \_\_\_\_."

| #  | Verb    | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                    |
|----|---------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| 10 | יֵאָכֵל | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓  |
| ✓  | יֵאָכֵל | Imperfect            | 3ms                  | אכל                  | Passive — it shall be eaten |

## Passage C — Genesis 21:23–31

21:23

הַשְׁבְּעָה לִי בְּאֵלֵהֶם הַנֶּה

"[11] \_\_\_\_ to me by God here."

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                             |
|----|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 11 | הִשָּׁבַעַה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓           |
| ✓  | הִשָּׁבַעַה | Imperative           | 2ms                  | שָׁבַע               | Reflexive — Swear! (bind yourself by |

21:24

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָהָם אֵלָיו אֲשָׁכֶּנּוּ

"And Abraham said, 'I [12] \_\_\_\_.'"

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                   |
|----|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------------|
| 12 | אֲשָׁכֶנּוּ | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓ |
| ✓  | אֲשָׁכֶנּוּ | Imperfect            | 1cs                  | שָׁבַע               | Reflexive — I will swear   |

21:31

כִּי שָׁם נִשְׁבָּעוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם

"For there [13] \_\_\_\_ both of them."

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                      |
|----|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------|
| 13 | נִשְׁבָּעוּ | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓    |
| ✓  | נִשְׁבָּעוּ | Weqatal              | 3mp                  | שָׁבַע               | Reflexive — they swore (bound |

## Bonus — Genesis 21:3, 21:8

21:3

אֲשֶׁר-נִוְלַד-לּוֹ

"who had been born to him"

21:8

וַיִּגְדַּל הַיֶּלֶד וַיִּגְמַל

"And the child grew and was weaned."

| #  | Verb       | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                    |
|----|------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| B1 | נִוְלַד    | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓  |
| ✓  | נִוְלַד    | Weqatal              | 3ms                  | יָלַד                | Passive — who had been born |
| B2 | וַיִּגְמַל | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓  |
| ✓  | וַיִּגְמַל | Wayyiqtol            | 3ms                  | גָּמַל               | Passive — was weaned        |

## Part C — Distractor Check

These three verbs come from the same passages. None are Niphal. Answer "No" for Niphal? and complete the full parse.

3:6

וַתֵּרָא הָאִשָּׁה כִּי טוֹב הָעֵץ לְמַאֲכָל

"So when the woman [D1] \_\_\_\_ that the tree was good for food."

| #  | Verb     | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                             |
|----|----------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| D1 | וַתֵּרָא | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓           |
| ✓  | וַתֵּרָא | Wayyiqtol            | 3fs                  | רָאָה                | NOT Niphal — Qal: and she saw; III-■ |

6:6

כִּי עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם בְּאָרֶץ

"that he [D2] \_\_\_\_ mankind on the earth."

| #  | Verb   | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                             |
|----|--------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| D2 | עָשָׂה | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓           |
| ✓  | עָשָׂה | Perfect              | 3ms                  | עָשָׂה               | NOT Niphal — Qal: he made/did; III-■ |

21:8

וַיִּגְדֹּל הַיֶּלֶד

"And [D3] \_\_\_\_ the child."

| #  | Verb        | Conjugation          | PGN                  | Root                 | Function                             |
|----|-------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| D3 | וַיִּגְדֹּל | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> see ↓           |
| ✓  | וַיִּגְדֹּל | Wayyiqtol            | 3ms                  | גָּדַל               | NOT Niphal — Qal: and he grew; plain |

Items 5–6 (■■■■■■■■■■ / ■■■■■■■■■■) are both from ■■■■■■, a verb that occurs almost exclusively in the Niphal. Items 11–13 all parse as Reflexive from ■■■■■■ — notice how Imperative, Imperfect, and Weqatal all express the same oath-swearing action.

**Score: 13 main + 2 bonus = 15 total. 13–15 = excellent | 9–12 = review the paradigm | below 9 = revisit §23.3–23.13**

## Conjugation Coverage

| Conjugation     | Verbs                                                                |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wayyiqtol (5)   | #3, #5, #7, #8, B2                                                   |
| Weqatal (5)     | #1, #6, #9, #13, B1                                                  |
| Imperfect (2)   | #10, #12                                                             |
| Participle (1)  | #2                                                                   |
| Imperative (1)  | #11                                                                  |
| Distractors (3) | D1 (Qal Wayyiqtol 3fs), D2 (Qal Perfect 3ms), D3 (Qal Wayyiqtol 3ms) |